

8. Recommendations (Critical)

1. Move fast to own the “intent layer”

You must:

- brand this category
- define the terminology

Example:

“Intent-based fraud detection”

If you don't, Stripe will.

2. Maximize data collection immediately

Your advantage is fragile.

Prioritize:

- Chrome Web Store launch
- user acquisition
- telemetry volume

Even small scale (10k users) = massive edge

3. Position as infrastructure, not extension

Do NOT market as:

- “fraud protection extension”

Position as:

“the first real-time fraud interception layer”

Because:

- extensions are features
- infrastructure gets acquired
- **Defend the "Extension" Moat aggressively.**

- *Why:* Because Plaid cannot build a Chrome extension (it ruins their B2B neutrality), and Aura cannot build technical interception (they are a marketing company). Launch the extension immediately to capture the "Edge" layer before someone like Cloudflare or Norton copies the UX.
- **Provisional Patent: Contextual Correlation.**
 - File for **"Systems and Methods for Correlating Email Threat Vectors with Peer-to-Peer Payment Memos."** This blocks Stripe or Sardine from simply "adding" this feature later.
- **Build the "Scam Memo" Lexicon for B2B.**
 - Use the free consumer tool to collect thousands of Zelle/PayPal memo texts labeled "fraud/not fraud." Create a benchmark dataset. When you pitch to Neobanks, you don't just sell an API; you sell **"Our model has seen 500,000 scam memos. Plaid's has only seen payment volumes."**

4. Tier 4 (Email Security) — High-End Narrative Marketing

Abnormal Security

Channels

- LinkedIn
- whitepapers
- webinars

Creative

HOOK

"Stop sophisticated phishing attacks"

ANGLE

- attackers are evolving fast

PROOF

- AI + behavioral analysis

3. What Nobody Is Doing (Marketing Layer)

This is where your advantage becomes obvious.

1. No one owns “scam psychology”

Everyone talks about:

- fraud systems
- AI detection

No one explains:

- **how scams actually manipulate people**

👉 This is a massive content opportunity

1. The Strategic Reality of SEO in This Market

There are **two completely different SEO universes**:

A. Enterprise Fraud SEO (DO NOT PRIORITIZE)

Dominated by:

- Sift
- Alloy

Keywords like:

- “fraud detection software”
- “AML compliance tools”

- 👉 Impossible to win early
 - 👉 Low relevance to your product anyway
-

B. Scam / Consumer Behavior SEO (YOUR ENTRY POINT)

This is:

- fragmented
- underserved
- high intent

Dominated weakly by:

- Aura
- Trend Micro

👉 This is where you attack

2. Immediate Keyword Clusters You Can Steal

Cluster 1: “Is this a scam?” (Highest ROI)

Keywords

- “is this paypal email a scam”
- “zelle scam email example”
- “is this payment request legit”
- “paypal invoice scam signs”
- “fake payment email what to do”

Why these are gold

- **User is actively being scammed**
- Real-time intent
- Extremely high conversion

Competitor weakness

- Articles are:
 - generic
 - outdated
 - not platform-specific
-

Your angle (unmatched)

Instead of:

“Here are 5 signs of a scam”

You write:

“This PayPal email is a scam — here’s exactly why (real example)”

👉 Specificity wins SEO now

Cluster 2: Payment Memo Behavior (You OWN this)

Keywords (low competition, high novelty)

- “what to write in zelle memo”
- “is zelle memo important”
- “paypal notes scam”
- “should you leave memo blank zelle”
- “payment memo fraud”

Why this is huge

No company is targeting this.

👉 You are literally creating this category

Content angle

“Scammers rely on what you write in the memo — here’s how”

Cluster 3: Platform-Specific Scam Queries

PayPal

- “paypal friends and family scam”
- “paypal invoice scam refund”
- “paypal payment request scam”

Zelle

- “zelle scam refund policy”
- “zelle fraud examples”
- “bank zelle scam what to do”

Gmail

- “gmail phishing examples”
 - “fake google security alert email”
-

Why these win

- Hyper-specific
 - High search volume spikes during scams
 - Weak content quality from competitors
-

Cluster 4: “What to do after scam” (Aura dominates—BUT weak depth)

Keywords

- “i got scammed on zelle what do i do”
- “paypal scam refund process”
- “can banks reverse zelle payments”

Competitors

- Aura
- LifeLock

Weakness

- Generic advice
 - No real tactical guidance
-

Your angle

“What actually works (and what doesn’t) after a Zelle scam”

Cluster 5: Scam Psychology (Untapped Category)

Keywords

- “why do people fall for scams”
 - “social engineering examples real”
 - “how scammers manipulate urgency”
 - “emotional manipulation scams”
-

Why this matters

This builds:

- authority
- backlinks
- long-term SEO moat

👉 No fraud company owns this

3. High-Conversion “Product Bridge” Keywords

These are critical.

They connect:

👉 problem → your product

Keywords

- “how to avoid paypal scams”
 - “how to stop zelle fraud”
 - “prevent payment scams online”
 - “tools to detect scams”
-

Competitor weakness

Most articles:

- list generic advice
 - don't offer real tools
-

Your advantage

You can say:

“Install this and it actually stops the payment”

👉 Massive conversion edge

4. Chrome Web Store SEO (Underrated Goldmine)

This is where you can win **fastest**.

Keywords

- “scam detector chrome”
- “paypal protection extension”
- “phishing gmail extension”

- “fraud protection browser”
-

Competitors

- Trend Micro
 - random low-quality extensions
-

Weakness

- outdated UX
 - poor messaging
 - no specificity
-

Your opportunity

Title:

“Stop PayPal & Zelle Scams Before You Send Money”

Description:

- include:
 - “Gmail scam detection”
 - “payment interception”
 - “real-time alerts”
-

5. Keyword Strategy Map (What to Prioritize)

Tier 1 (Immediate)

High intent, low competition:

- “paypal email scam”

- “zelle scam what to do”
- “payment request scam”

👉 Publish 10–20 articles here ASAP

Tier 2 (Category Creation)

- “payment memo scam”
- “intent-based fraud detection”

👉 You define this space

Tier 3 (Authority Building)

- scam psychology
- social engineering

👉 Long-term moat

6. Exact Content Titles You Should Ship

These are engineered to rank:

High Intent

- “This PayPal Email Is a Scam (Real Example Breakdown)”
 - “Zelle Scam: What Actually Happens After You Send Money”
 - “I Got a Payment Request — Is It Legit?”
-

Unique Angle (no competition)

- “Why the Payment Memo Is the Most Dangerous Part of a Scam”
- “Scammers Count on This One Thing Before You Hit Send”

Conversion

- “How to Stop PayPal Scams Before You Send Money”
 - “The Only Way to Catch a Scam Before You Pay”
-

7. Critical Insight Most Founders Miss

SEO is not about traffic.

It's about:

👉 **capturing users at the exact moment of vulnerability**

Right now:

- Aura captures them **after**
- Sift captures businesses **before**

You can capture:

👉 **during**

Final Strategic Take

You are sitting on a **perfect SEO wedge**:

Layer	Owned by
Enterprise fraud	Sift

Identity	Secure
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Post-scam	Aura
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Real-time scam detection	NOBODY
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What You Should Do Next (Concrete)

1. Publish **15 articles in 2 weeks**
2. Focus **ONLY** on:
 - PayPal
 - Zelle
 - Gmail scams
3. Use:
 - real examples
 - screenshots
 - breakdowns

This is all good

You are not launching:

- a Chrome extension
- a fraud tool

You are launching:

the first real-time scam interception layer

That distinction determines:

- your messaging
 - your channels
 - your velocity
-

Because:

👉 Bundled fraud only works at the **transaction layer**

What Stripe can see:

- transaction amount
 - user history
 - device signals
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What Stripe CANNOT see:

- the Gmail message that caused the payment
- the psychological manipulation
- the intent behind the memo

7. The correct positioning (non-negotiable)

You must position as:

“We stop scams before the transaction even becomes fraud.”

That is fundamentally different.

Reframe the timeline

Traditional fraud systems

1. Transaction is initiated
 2. System evaluates risk
 3. Maybe blocks it
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Your system

1. Scam email arrives
 2. User is manipulated
 3. User attempts payment
 4. **You interrupt BEFORE execution**
-

- 👉 You operate earlier in the timeline
 - 👉 That is why bundling doesn't kill you
-

8. Long-term implication (very important)

Eventually:

- Stripe
- PayPal
- banks

will try to move upstream.

But they will struggle because:

- they don't control the browser
 - they don't see cross-platform behavior
 - they don't have your dataset
-

9. The real strategic takeaway

Most founders try to:

- build a better product

- compete inside an existing category

That is a losing game here.

You are doing something more powerful:

You are inserting yourself **before the category even activates**

Final Insight (This is the key)

Fraud companies fight over:

“Was this transaction fraudulent?”

You are answering:

“**Should this transaction ever happen?**”

That is not a feature improvement.

That is a **different layer of reality in the stack.**

If you understand this correctly, your entire strategy changes:

- you don't compete on accuracy
- you don't compete on pricing
- you don't integrate like them

You:

👉 **change when the decision happens**

Strategic Opportunity:

- **Own the "Memo Score":** Create a specific API endpoint called POST /score_memo that takes a string (payment memo/description) and returns a scam probability. Stripe does not offer this as a standalone service.

Top 3 Moves Based on This Intel

- 1. **Defend the "Extension" Moat aggressively.**
 - Why: Because Plaid cannot build a Chrome extension (it ruins their B2B neutrality), and Aura cannot build technical interception (they are a marketing company). Launch the extension immediately to capture the "Edge" layer before someone like Cloudflare or Norton copies the UX.
- 2. **Provisional Patent: Contextual Correlation.**
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grade marketing strategy tailored specifically for Safety Intercept's unique position: a free Chrome extension with a B2B data monetization engine underneath.

The strategy is built on one core truth: **You don't need to pay for users. You need to intercept them where they are already afraid.**

Executive Summary: The Asymmetric Strategy

Standard Chrome Extension Marketing	Safety Intercept's Asymmetric Play
Compete on features	Compete on fear + trust
Pay for Google Ads	Hijack scam-victim search intent
Build a following	Own the "scam check" micro-moment
Sell subscriptions	Give away the tool, sell the data

Your unfair advantage: You are the *only* extension that can read Gmail *and* intercept Zelle/PayPal. That is not a feature—it is a **moat**. Market the interception, not the detection.

Phase 1: Pre-Launch (Next 14 Days)

1.1 Own the "Scam Check" Search Intent (Zero-Cost Growth Engine)

Most scam victims Google *after* losing money. You need to intercept them *before*.

Action: Create 5-10 blog posts answering the exact questions people type when they are suspicious:

Search Query	Your Blog Post Title	CTA
"Is this Zelle payment a scam?"	"3 Red Flags in Zelle Memos That Mean 'Scam' (2026)"	Install Safety Intercept to check before you send
"PayPal friends and family scam"	"The PayPal F&F Trick That Cost Me \$2,000 (And How to Stop It)"	One-click protection
"How to know if an email from my bank is real"	"Gmail Scam Detector: 5 Seconds to Know if That Email is Fake"	Free Chrome extension
"Can someone scam me through Zelle?"	"Yes. Here's Exactly How They Do It (And How to Block Them)"	Install now

Why this works: These searchers have *high intent*—they are literally holding their mouse over the "Send" button. They need an answer *now*. Your extension is the answer.

Distribution: Post these articles on Medium, LinkedIn, and Reddit (r/Scams, r/ChromeExtensions). Each post ends with: *"Install Safety Intercept—it reads the memo before you send it."*

1.2 Chrome Web Store Optimization (The Non-Negotiable)

The Chrome Web Store is your primary conversion channel . Optimize ruthlessly:

Element	Your Strategy
Title	"Safety Intercept: Scam Blocker for Zelle, PayPal & Gmail" (keywords front-loaded)
Short Description	"Intercepts scam payments before you lose money. Reads Gmail + blocks fake Zelle/PayPal memos."
Icon	Shield + intercept symbol (red stop sign + green check). High contrast.
Screenshots (5)	1. Gmail scam alert popup 2. Zelle payment intercept screen 3. PayPal warning 4. Settings panel 5. "You just avoided a scam" success screen
Demo Video	15 seconds: User receives scam email → goes to PayPal → extension blocks it. Show the <i>interception</i> , not the interface.
Permissions Requested	Minimal. Ask for Gmail + PayPal/Zelle domains only. Too many permissions = instant distrust

Critical: Your first 10 reviews are everything . Recruit friends, family, and the UC Berkeley community to install and leave honest 5-star reviews within the first week of launch.

1.3 Directory Submission Blitz (SEO Foundation)

New extensions have zero domain authority. Directory backlinks are the fastest way to build it .

Action: Submit to 50+ directories immediately:

- **Launch platforms:** Product Hunt, BetaList, Uned, AlternativeTo
- **Extension directories:** Crx4Chrome, Extpose, Chromeifyi
- **Startup directories:** AngelList, StartupBuffer, BetaPage

Why this matters for B2B later: When a neobank CTO searches "fraud detection API," your domain needs to rank. Directory backlinks build that authority for free .

Phase 2: Launch Week (Day 1-7)

2.1 The "Scam Intercept" Launch on Product Hunt

Product Hunt is the single best source of early, tech-savvy users who leave reviews .

Strategy:

- Launch on a **Tuesday** (highest engagement)
- Prepare a 60-second demo video showing a real scam interception
- Post the launch in relevant Facebook groups and Slack communities *before* going live
- Tag cybersecurity influencers on X/Twitter to amplify

The Hook for Product Hunt:

"We built a Chrome extension that reads your Gmail and blocks Zelle/PayPal payments if the memo matches a scam pattern. 500ms response time. Free forever. Built by a UC Berkeley student."

2.2 Reddit Ambush (Intent-Based Harvesting)

Reddit has millions of users asking "Is this a scam?" in real-time . Go to them.

Target Subreddits:

- r/Scams (200k+ members—your ideal user)
- r/ChromeExtensions
- r/personalfinance
- r/ScamsAwareness
- r/ScamAlert

Tactic: Search for "Zelle scam," "PayPal friends and family," "is this email real" every morning. Reply with helpful answers + a soft CTA.

Example Comment:

"That 'security deposit' request on Zelle is a classic scam. The memo 'hold payment' is a red flag. I actually built a free Chrome extension that reads memos and blocks these in real-time—happy to share the link if you want to protect yourself going forward."

Do not spam. Provide value first. The conversion rate from helpful Reddit comments is surprisingly high because the intent is already there .

2.3 YouTube Shorts & TikTok (Viral Hook)

Short-form video is the most powerful discovery tool for software in 2026 .

Create 5 videos in one afternoon:

Video Concept	Hook (First 3 Seconds)	Visual
"The Zelle Trick"	"I almost lost \$1,500 on Zelle yesterday."	Screen recording of scam email → Zelle payment → extension blocks
"PayPal F&F Scam"	"Never use PayPal Friends and Family for this."	Side-by-side: with extension vs. without
"Gmail Scam That Fooled Me"	"This email looked exactly like my bank."	Show the fake email → extension flags it
"How Scammers Use Memos"	"That 'deposit for puppy' memo? It's a lie."	Memo examples side-by-side
"Install This Before You Send Money"	"One click. 500ms. Saves your money."	Fast montage of intercepts

Post to: TikTok, YouTube Shorts, Instagram Reels, X/Twitter.

Hashtags: #scamalert #zellescam #paypalscam #chromeextension #fraudprotection

Phase 3: Growth (Month 1-3)

3.1 The "Viral Loop" Feature (Most Important)

Your extension should *market itself*. Add a post-intercept share screen:

After blocking a scam, show:

"Safety Intercept just saved you from losing \$[amount]. Share this with a friend who uses Zelle →"

With share buttons for: WhatsApp, SMS, Messenger, X/Twitter.

Why this works: People who almost get scammed are *highly motivated* to warn others. You become the tool they recommend.

3.2 Partner with Scam-Awareness Influencers

There are dozens of TikTok/YouTube creators who make scam-explainer content (e.g., @scamfish, @pleasantgreen, @kitboga). They have millions of views.

Outreach Script:

"Hi [Name], love your scam-baiting content. I built a free Chrome extension that intercepts Zelle/PayPal scams in real-time by reading the payment memo. Would you be open to trying it and mentioning it in a video? No sponsorship money—just a tool your audience actually needs."

Value prop to them: They get exclusive content (watching their extension block a scam live) and their audience gets a free safety tool.

3.3 Email List (The B2B Asset)

Every user who installs the extension gets a "Welcome" email (use their Chrome email if permission granted, or collect via popup).

Email Sequence:

1. **Day 0:** "You're protected. Here's how it works."
2. **Day 3:** "3 scam patterns we blocked this week" (builds trust + engagement)
3. **Day 7:** "Want early access to our B2B fraud API?" (qualify B2B leads)

Why this matters: Your B2B buyers (neobanks, credit unions) are also *consumers*. Build an email list of 10,000+ users, and you have a direct channel to pitch your API.

Phase 4: The B2B Data Flywheel (The Real Monetization)

Your free consumer tool is not a product—it is a **data collection engine**.

The Flywheel:

1. **Free extension** → users install
2. **Scam attempts** → extension collects labeled memo data (scam vs. not scam)
3. **Proprietary dataset** → "The largest labeled scam-memo database"
4. **B2B API pitch** → "Our model has seen 500,000 scam memos. Plaid's hasn't."

How to Talk to B2B Buyers (Neobanks, Credit Unions)

When you have 5,000+ users, email the Head of Fraud at:

- Chime
- Varo
- Current
- SoFi
- Local credit unions

Email Template:

Subject: 500,000 scam memos your model hasn't seen

Hi [Name],

We built a Chrome extension that intercepts Zelle/PayPal scams by scoring payment memos in real-time. In [X] months, we've collected [Y] labeled scam memos—a dataset no one else has.

We're building an API that scores memos for fraud risk. Would you be open to a 15-min call to see if this fills a gap in your current fraud stack?

Built by UC Berkeley. Free for consumers. API for fintechs.

Recommended Marketing Budget (\$0)

Tactic	Cost	Expected Impact
Directory submissions (DIY)	\$0	SEO foundation + backlinks
Reddit engagement	\$0	100-500 early users
YouTube Shorts/TikTok	\$0	Viral potential
Product Hunt launch	\$0	500-2,000 users if successful
Chrome Web Store optimization	\$0	Ongoing organic discovery
Email sequence	\$0	B2B lead gen

Do not pay for ads. Your unit economics don't work yet. Focus on intent-based harvesting and organic growth .

Immediate Action Items (Next 7 Days)

Day	Action	Time
1	Write 5 blog posts targeting scam-search keywords	3 hours
2	Optimize Chrome Web Store listing (title, description, screenshots, video)	4 hours
3	Submit to 50+ directories (start with free ones)	2 hours
4	Create 5 YouTube Shorts/TikToks	3 hours
5	Draft Product Hunt launch page + write outreach scripts for influencers	2 hours
6	Set up welcome email sequence	1 hour
7	Post in r/Scams and r/ChromeExtensions (value-first comments)	1 hour

Total time investment: ~16 hours for a complete launch engine that keeps delivering users for months.

The One Thing That Will Kill Your Growth

Asking for too many permissions.

Users are terrified of browser extensions after stories like ShieldGuard, which harvested crypto wallet data from thousands of users . The #1 reason users uninstall or refuse extensions is permission anxiety .

Safety Intercept's advantage: You only need Gmail + PayPal/Zelle domains. State that clearly in your store listing: *"We only request permissions we need. No browsing history. No passwords. Just scam protection."*

Trust is your product. Do not violate it.

Want me to write the actual blog posts or Product Hunt launch copy next?